

UPWORK

TONE OF VOICE

Upwork Tone of Voice for Paid Ads

1) Voice to embody in ads

- Clear & concise — plain words, specific, get to the point fast.
 - Supportive & perceptive — acknowledge needs, encourage with practical language.
 - Calm, collected, guiding — steer without pressure, offer direction and reassurance.
 - Professional — warm and human, never flippant or pushy.
 - **Tone should feel:** direct, supportive, considerate, grounded, truthful — with an occasional wink.
Never: wordy, robotic, overpromising, irreverent.
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2) Audience

- Clients (SMB): Direct, actionable, confident, clear, supportive; sometimes light levity and fun.
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3) Funnel guidance

- Awareness (prospecting): Hook, clarity, connection.
 - Consideration (retargeting): Clarity + proof (ratings, verified history).
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4) Headlines & hooks

- 95/5 rule: 95% informative/helpful, 5% subtle personality ("wink").
 - General: "Your shortcut to standout hires"
 - Copilot: "Work smart, not solo with Upwork"
 - AI × Talent: "Advanced AI. Human touch. Exceptional outcomes."
 - Talent: "Finally, hiring that doesn't feel like work"
 - Impact: "From ideas to outcomes — fast"
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5) Offer framing & proof

- Emphasize ease & speed: post, review, hire fast.
- Surface trust: ratings, verified history.

- Suggest cost effectiveness without sounding like we're cheap or low quality.
 - Clarity first, entertainment second.
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6) Terminology & naming

- Use: client (hirer), **freelancer/independent contractor/freelance professional** (doer). *Talent* is singular.
 - Uma, Upwork's Mindful AI™ (first mention). Then "Uma™" or "Uma" if context is clear.
 - AI always uppercase; "artificial intelligence" lowercase.
 - Avoid: *click/tap/swipe/press*, directional UI (*above/below*), **escrow** (say *project funds*).
 - Follow spelling list: *email, website, WiFi, homepage*, etc.
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7) Emojis & punctuation

- Use sparingly in on-image copy when they make it punchy or fun. Use emojis in description copy in bulleted lists instead of bullet points.
 - Keep punctuation simple & consistent for scannability.
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8) On-brand CTAs

- Always verb-led, device-agnostic: *Learn more, Find talent, Post a job, Start free.*
 - Avoid "Click here."
 - Focus on what the **user** can do.
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9) Quick ad-copy checklist

- Clarity in line 1: payoff obvious, short, scannable.
 - Tone: supportive, confident, grounded; subtle wink optional.
 - Audience fit: speak to small businesses
 - Proof: include ratings/verified history when possible.
 - Terminology: correct brand naming, Uma™ handled properly.
 - CTA: single, clear, user-action-led.
 - Compliance: no overpromising; professional & respectful.
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10) Starter ad-ready lines

- Prospecting:

- "Finally, hiring that doesn't feel like work"
- "Work smart, not solo with Upwork"
- "Advanced AI. Human touch. Exceptional outcomes"
- Retargeting:
 - "Guiding you to go-to talent, fast"
 - "From ideas to outcomes — fast"